

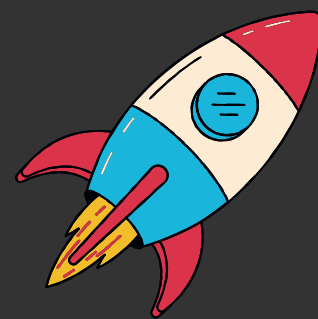
API Terminology Handbook



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The Ultimate guide to
Rest API Terms and
Glossary



What is Rest API ?

REST (Representational State Transfer) is a software architectural style used for building web services. It is based on a set of principles for the design of networked applications and is often used for building web services that are lightweight, maintainable, and scalable.



Some common terms used in REST API:

- Resource
- Endpoint
- Method
- Request
- Response
- URI (Uniform Resource Identifier)
- URL (Uniform Resource Locator)
- Status codes
- Content-Type
- Header
- Payload
- Stateless
- Cacheable
- Self-descriptive message
- HATEOAS



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Resource

Representation of a thing or an entity that can be accessed and manipulated using the API.

Endpoint

Unique URL representing a specific resource or set of resources.

Method

type of request that can be made to an endpoint, such as GET, POST, PUT, and DELETE.



Request

Message sent to an endpoint to retrieve or update a resource.

Response

Message sent back to the client in response to a request.

URI (Uniform Resource Identifier)

String of characters used to identify a name or a resource on the Internet.



URL (Uniform Resource Locator)

A specific type of URI that specifies the location of a resource on the Internet.

Status codes:

HTTP status codes are used to indicate the success or failure of an API request. Some common status codes include 200 (OK), 201 (Created), 400 (Bad Request), and 404 (Not Found).

Content-Type

The Content-Type header tells the server what format the request body is in and how it should be processed.



Header:

Headers are used to pass additional information about the request or the response.

Payload

The payload is the data sent in the request body.

Stateless

A REST API is stateless, which means that the server does not store any information about the client between requests.



Cacheable

A REST API can be cacheable, which means that the server can store a copy of the response and reuse it for future requests.

Self-descriptive message

Each message sent in a REST API contains all the information necessary to understand and process it, including the request and response formats, status codes, and headers.

HATEOAS

Hypermedia as the Engine of Application State is a feature of REST API, in which the API includes links that let the client navigate through the resources and perform actions.



Conclusion

In conclusion, REST API (Representational State Transfer) is a software architectural style used for building web services. It is based on a set of principles for the design of networked applications and is often used for building web services that are lightweight, maintainable, and scalable. REST API uses standard HTTP methods, such as GET, POST, PUT, and DELETE, to interact with resources represented by URIs. Each resource is identified by a unique URI and can be manipulated using the appropriate HTTP method. REST API also uses standard HTTP status codes to indicate the success or failure of a request and can be cached to improve performance. REST API's simplicity, scalability, and flexibility make it an ideal choice for building web services and has become the de facto standard for web services development.

